THYME 4 SLEEP
PEDIATRIC SLEEP COACHING

Wake Windows & Naps

Typical ranges for healthy, full-term little ones. Use them as a starting point — your child's cues come first.

AGE	WAKE WINDOW	NAPS	DAY SLEEP	NIGHT SLEEP	BEDTIME
0–3 months	**45 min – 1.5 hr**	4–6 (often short)	4–6 hr	8–10 hr (with feeds)	Late & fluid — often 9–11pm
4–5 months	**1.5 – 2.5 hr**	3–4	3–4 hr	10–12 hr	6:30 – 8:00pm
6–8 months	**2 – 3 hr**	3 → 2	2.5–3.5 hr	11–12 hr	6:30 – 7:30pm
9–12 months	**3 – 4 hr**	2	2–3 hr	11–12 hr	6:30 – 7:30pm
12–18 months	**3.5 – 5.5 hr**	2 → 1	2–3 hr	11–12 hr	6:45 – 7:45pm
18 months – 3 yrs	**5 – 6.5 hr**	1	1–2.5 hr	10.5–12 hr	7:00 – 8:00pm
3–5 years	—	0–1 (quiet time)	0–1.5 hr	10–12 hr	7:00 – 8:00pm

Total sleep in 24 hours

0–3 MONTHS	4–5 MONTHS	6–8 MONTHS	9–12 MONTHS	12–18 MONTHS	18 MONTHS – 3 YRS	3–5 YEARS
14–17 hr	12–16 hr	12–16 hr	12–16 hr	11–14 hr	11–14 hr	10–13 hr

Sleepy cues — start the routine

Slowing down · staring off · rubbing eyes or ears · first yawn · quieter, "glassy" look · losing interest in toys.

Overtired cues — go earlier tomorrow

Second wind & zoomies · arching · fighting the feed · crying at lay-down · catnaps under 30 min · 5am wake-ups.

Rule of thumb: the shortest wake window is usually first thing in the morning; the longest is before bedtime. Adjust in 15-minute steps and hold each change for 3 days before judging it.

General guidance only — not medical advice.

Sample Daily Rhythms

Real-life shapes of a day. Times are illustrative — shift the whole day earlier or later to suit your family.

6–8 months (2 naps)

7:00	Wake + milk feed
8:00	Breakfast solids
9:30	Nap 1 (60–90 min)
11:00	Milk feed
12:00	Lunch solids
13:30	Nap 2 (60–90 min)
15:30	Milk feed
17:00	Dinner solids
18:15	Bath, PJs, feed (lights on)
18:40	Books, song, key phrase
19:00	In crib awake · lights out

9–12 months (2 naps)

7:00	Wake + milk feed
8:00	Breakfast
10:00	Nap 1 (60–90 min)
12:00	Lunch
14:30	Nap 2 (45–90 min)
15:30	Snack + milk
17:15	Dinner
18:30	Bath, PJs, milk outside bedroom
18:50	Books, song, key phrase
19:00	In crib awake · lights out

15–24 months (1 nap)

7:00	Wake · curtains open · breakfast
9:30	Snack · outdoor play
11:45	Lunch
12:30	Nap (1.5–2.5 hr)
15:00	Snack + milk
17:30	Dinner
18:45	Bath, PJs, teeth
19:05	Books, song, key phrase
19:15	In bed awake · lights out

2–3 years (1 nap)

7:00	Toddler clock turns green · wake
7:30	Breakfast
12:00	Lunch
13:00	Nap or quiet time (cap at ~2 hr)
15:00	Snack
17:30	Dinner
18:50	Bath, PJs, teeth, routine chart
19:15	Books, chat, key phrase
19:30	Lights out

Anchor the morning

Same wake-up time (±30 min), every day — even after a rough night. Curtains open, daylight in.

Feed early, not to sleep

Offer the bedtime milk near the start of the routine, with lights on, so sleep isn't tied to sucking.

Down awake

Calm and drowsy is fine — but let the last step into sleep be theirs. That's the skill that connects night cycles.

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